

Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology

Literature (BA) with Pre-Law Concentration

Students who complete the major in Literature receive a thorough grounding in literary ideas and methods, competence in particular national literatures, as well as the ability to work across literatures and languages. By engaging literary works appropriate to one of the country's most diverse campuses, this major teaches both specialized knowledge and the skills to deepen and broaden knowledge of literature that is new or unfamiliar. The ideal graduate would be able to approach English-language literary works from anywhere in the world with a set of intelligent questions and the capacity to produce equally intelligent solutions to interpretative problems. By selecting a variety of courses from a variety of headings, students are able to combine courses in criticism and interpretation, in writing and translation, and in English and foreign languages. Students may also pursue teaching certification.

The study of literature in general--with its emphasis on writing, close reading, and textual interpretation--already helps students to develop many of the core skills that they will need to succeed in law school. Students in the Pre-Law Concentration receive the same rigorous training in literary studies as all Literature majors but they complete, in addition, a selection of law-related courses that help them not only to better understand the law but also to sharpen the research, writing, and analytical skills that they will need in legal careers.

At least one-half of the semester credit hours for the major must be taken at UT Dallas.

Bachelor of Arts in Literature with Pre-Law Concentration

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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Professors: Sean J. Cotter, Pamela Gossin, Ming Dong Gu, Dennis M. Kratz, Manuel (Manny) Martinez, David A. Patterson, Rene Prieto, Rainer Schulte, Theresa M. Towner

Associate Professors: Ashley Barnes, John C. Gooch, Charles Hatfield

Assistant Professors: Erin Greer, Maurine Ogbaa, Davis Smith-Brecheisen, Nomi Stone, Mai Wang

Chair Emerita: Zsuzsanna Ozsvath

Professors Emeriti: Milton A. Cohen, Timothy (Tim) Redman, Michael S. Simpson, Frederick Turner

Associate Professor Emerita: Patricia H. Michaelson

Professors of Instruction: Lorena Camacho-Guardardo, Christopher (Chris) Ryan

Associate Professors of Instruction: Zafar Anjum, Kenneth Brewer, Bei Chen, Peter (Jay) Ingrao

Associate Professor of Instruction Emeritus: Thomas M. Lambert

Assistant Professors of Instruction: Chieko Hoki, Christina Montgomery, Angela Mooney, Kristin Riley

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours^{[1](#)}

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

[RHET 1302](#) Rhetoric

[RHET 2302](#) Intermediate Composition and Rhetoric

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

[LIT 2331](#) Introduction to World Literature^{[2](#)}

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses

II. Major Requirements: 45-48 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

Major Preparatory Courses: 6-9 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

[LIT 2350](#) Close Reading

Choose 6 semester credit hours from the following four:

[LIT 2320](#) Survey A: Literature in English

[LIT 2321](#) Survey B: Literature in Translation

[LIT 2322](#) Survey of African-American and African Diaspora Literatures

[LIT 2331](#) Introduction to World Literature²

Major Core Courses: 12 semester credit hours

[LIT 3300](#) Western Literary Tradition

[LIT 3339](#) Writing Literary Studies

[LIT 4329](#) Single Author

[LIT 4390](#) Capstone

Major Distribution and Elective Courses: 12 semester credit hours

3 semester credit hours from the following "Research and Writing" courses:

[LIT 3338](#) Literary Theory and Aesthetic Philosophy

Any upper-division creative writing workshop (prefix [CRWT](#))

6 semester credit hours from the following "Contexts" course:

[LIT 3319](#) Contexts³

3 semester credit hours from the following "Comparisons" courses:

[CRWT 3330](#) Translation Workshop

[LIT 3337](#) Comparisons

Pre-Law Concentration Requirements: 15 semester credit hours

[PSCI 3303](#) Civil Liberties

[PSCI 3322](#) Constitutional Law

[RHET 4320](#) Legal Research and Writing

[ISIS 4304](#) Trials in American Culture

Select 3 semester credit hours from the following:

[HIST 4342](#) Islamic Law and Society

[ISIS 4303](#) Business Law and Culture

[PSCI 3351](#) Comparative Courts and Law

[PSCI 4301](#) Law, Science, and Policy

or [PPOL 4301](#) Law, Science, and Policy

[PSCI 4310](#) Law and Terrorism

[PSCI 4363](#) International Law

[PSCI 4364](#) Civil Rights Law and Society

[PSCI 4V66](#) Mock Trial

[PSCI 4V67](#) Moot Court

III. Elective Requirements: 30-33 semester credit hours

Free Electives: 27-30 semester credit hours

Both upper-division and lower-division courses may be used as electives.

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

Incoming freshmen must enroll and complete requirements of [AHTC 1100](#).

1. Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.
2. A required Major Preparatory Course that also fulfills a Core Curriculum requirement. Semester credit hours may be counted in Core Curriculum.
3. LIT 3319 may be repeated for credit as topics vary.

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